

Interview Transcription:

Interaction of Labourer with Siddarth in Kannada via Phone Call.

Siddarth: How do you usually know when you have work for the day? Do you receive details about the job before going?

Labourer: The owner calls us in the morning or sometimes at the last minute. There is no fixed schedule. Some days we know early, some days suddenly. Only basic information like location. We usually don't know the exact quantity of goods or how much time it will take.

Siddarth: Are the required number of labourers always correctly assigned for the job?

Labourer: Not always. Sometimes we reach and realize more people are needed. Then the owner calls someone else.

Siddarth: So there is a mis estimate , how often does this happen and what happens if fewer labourers are sent?

Labourer: This happens around 2-3 times per month and because of this work becomes slow. Customers may get angry. Sometimes we need an extra trip or work longer hours.

Siddarth: How are your working hours recorded? Do you know how many hours you worked in a week?

Labourer: There is no written record. The owner keeps a rough idea of how long we worked. Some days are long trips, some are short.

Siddarth: How are you paid?

Labourer: We are paid weekly based on the owner's calculation.

Siddarth: Who checks the restoration of equipment used for loading and unloading goods? Like ropes, belts, harnesses, crates. Does this equipment get damaged or lost?

Labourer: There is no fixed checking. We put it back in the vehicle. If something is missing, the owner asks later. Sometimes during heavy loading belts get cut, the crate breaks and other damage happens. And sometimes during peak season , we forget to take our equipment back.

Siddarth: Okay sir , thank you for your time.

Summary:

Siddarth interviews a labourer who works in the local logistics service to understand daily operational challenges.

The labourer explains that work assignments are communicated through phone calls from the owner, often at the last minute, with no fixed schedule. Only basic details like location are provided, and they usually do not know the exact quantity of goods or expected duration of work beforehand.

There are frequent **miscalculations in labour allocation**, occurring about 2–3 times per month. When fewer labourers are assigned than required, work slows down, customers become dissatisfied, and sometimes extra trips or longer working hours are needed.

There is no formal system to record working hours; the owner maintains only a rough estimate. Payments are made weekly based on the owner's calculations rather than documented records.

Regarding equipment such as ropes, belts, harnesses, and crates, there is no proper tracking or checking mechanism. Items are simply placed back in the vehicle after use. Equipment is sometimes damaged during heavy loading or forgotten during peak seasons, leading to losses without systematic accountability.

Overall, the labourer highlights issues related to **lack of scheduling, poor labour estimation, absence of work-hour tracking, informal payroll calculation, and no structured equipment management system**.